ECONOMIC NINJA

Tax Liens

Due Diligence Checklist

Decide what qualifiers are important to you when deciding what to bid on.

Here are some questions to ask yourself. Keep in mind that some of the answers may be more or less important depending on whether you are purchasing a lien or a deed. For instance, you may not care as much whether the property seems to be in a good part of town if you are purchasing a lien. (It might matter more if purchasing a deed because it could affect the ease of re-sale. Although, virtually anything will eventually sell for the right price.)

- **Am I okay with purchasing a tax lien on blank land?**
- **Do I think that an occupied property might be more likely to redeem in a timely manner than a vacant lot?**
- **Do I care if the property looks decent or not?**
- **Do I care if the property is in a nice area or not?**

Directions: Following are the steps. The actual checklist is on page 2.

Get a general view of a property: Utilize *Google Earth*

Use Satellite View
Use Street View if available
* Look at the property and surrounding area.

Confirm the location of the property: Utilize the county website

Use the GIS portal to confirm the following:

A) location
B) parcel number
C) address and zoning

View the property tax record: Utilize the county tax collector or assessor's website:

(You can usually search by parcel number, address, or owner's name)

A) Search for additional/previous unpaid taxes on the property.
B) Search for other liens on the property.
C) Does the mailing address match the physical address? If yes, then the property may be owner occupied. If not, it may be tenant occupied, unoccupied, or the owner might just like to use a mailing address rather than the physical.

Tax Liens Due Diligence Checklist page 2

Determine the estimated property value

Residential:

A) *Redfin* - home value estimator
B) *Zillow*
C) *Propstream*

Vacant land:

Redfin standard site for comparable listings and recent sales

Commercial property:

Loopnet for comparable properties/buildings and uses

Directions: Record all notes and specific information from your research on the **Property Pre-Auction Research** worksheet.

Lien Cert. #, Address, & APN	Viewed the property using Google Earth	Confirmed the location using the county website	Viewed the property tax record using the tax collector's or assessor's website	Determined the estimated property value using Zillow, Redfin, Propstream, etc.
Cert #: Address: APN:	□ Satellite View □ Street View	□ location □ parcel number □ address & zoning	□ searched for other taxes □ searched for other liens □ compared addresses	what you have determined that the estimated property value is: _____
Cert #: Address: APN:	□ Satellite View □ Street View	□ location □ parcel number □ address & zoning	□ searched for other taxes □ searched for other liens □ compared addresses	what you have determined that the estimated property value is: _____
Cert #: Address: APN:	□ Satellite View □ Street View	□ location □ parcel number □ address & zoning	□ searched for other taxes □ searched for other liens □ compared addresses	what you have determined that the estimated property value is: _____
Cert #: Address: APN:	□ Satellite View □ Street View	□ location □ parcel number □ address & zoning	□ searched for other taxes □ searched for other liens □ compared addresses	what you have determined that the estimated property value is: _____

Tax Liens Due Diligence Checklist page 3 (or _____)

Directions: Record all notes and specific information from your research on the **Property Pre-Auction Research** worksheet.

Lien Cert. #, Address, & APN	Viewed the property using Google Earth	Confirmed the location using the county website	Viewed the property tax record using the county tax collector's or assessor's website	Determined the estimated property value using Zillow, Redfin, Propstream, etc.
Cert #: Address: APN:	☐ Satellite View ☐ Street View	☐ location ☐ parcel number ☐ address & zoning	☐ searched for other taxes ☐ searched for other liens ☐ compared addresses	what you have determined that the estimated property value is: _____
Cert #: Address: APN:	☐ Satellite View ☐ Street View	☐ location ☐ parcel number ☐ address & zoning	☐ searched for other taxes ☐ searched for other liens ☐ compared addresses	what you have determined that the estimated property value is: _____
Cert #: Address: APN:	☐ Satellite View ☐ Street View	☐ location ☐ parcel number ☐ address & zoning	☐ searched for other taxes ☐ searched for other liens ☐ compared addresses	what you have determined that the estimated property value is: _____
Cert #: Address: APN:	☐ Satellite View ☐ Street View	☐ location ☐ parcel number ☐ address & zoning	☐ searched for other taxes ☐ searched for other liens ☐ compared addresses	what you have determined that the estimated property value is: _____
Cert #: Address: APN:	☐ Satellite View ☐ Street View	☐ location ☐ parcel number ☐ address & zoning	☐ searched for other taxes ☐ searched for other liens ☐ compared addresses	what you have determined that the estimated property value is: _____
Cert #: Address: APN:	☐ Satellite View ☐ Street View	☐ location ☐ parcel number ☐ address & zoning	☐ searched for other taxes ☐ searched for other liens ☐ compared addresses	what you have determined that the estimated property value is: _____